standards, and inherent unfairness in the existing global monetary and financial governance regimes, both formal and informal, that have privileged the incumbent powers, particularly the United States.

Russia and China have been the most critical of contemporary global financial governance. Russia, whose government originated the BRICs as a club, has also done much of the hard work to propel the club forward. China and Russia also have been directly and intensely interested in all four of the financial statecraft initiatives described in Chapter 3. Diversification of international currency reserves and monetary sovereignty gradually became more significant Russian priorities, as the country shifted from its 1990s weakness and default to become a major international creditor. With the return of economic stagnation, however, Russia is in danger of falling back again to the position of rule taker instead of rule maker. China's position has moved from caution and circumspection over the goal of RMB internationalization to much greater willingness, particularly under President Xi, to articulate currency expansion as an explicit state aim.

While each of the three democracies have been somewhat ambivalent about promoting dedollarization and RMB internationalization, neither of which is necessarily in their economic interest, they also employ the BRICS platform to magnify their strength and voice. For example, Indian leaders have been happy to utilize the BRICS and its new institution, the NDB, to demonstrate, to the larger world, the financial expertise of their nationals. The center-right government that assumed power in Brazil in mid-2016 notably downplayed other South-South initiatives, but has maintained its BRICS identity as one of its foreign policy priorities. Although South Africa has fewer specific grievances accumulated over time with existing global financial governance, Pretoria, sensibly, considered the invitation to join the BRICS group as a windfall. Brazil and South Africa each missed the March 2017 deadline to ratify their membership in the China-led AIIB, due to a combination of financial difficulties and a desire to prioritize the NDB: to maintain appearances, China granted the two countries a year's extension.

Proposition 2. Collective financial statecraft among the BRICS countries is more likely when each country perceives threats to its sovereignty or autonomy to act, particularly in its respective region.

The principles of national sovereignty and domestic political autonomy resonate most powerfully among the three Asian and Eurasian BRICS: